

Bylaws of 50501 Inc.

Article I – Name and Purpose

Section 1.1 – Name

The official name of this organization shall be 50501 Inc. It is a nonprofit corporation legally formed under the laws of the Commonwealth of Virginia and duly registered as a foreign nonprofit entity within the District of Columbia, enabling lawful operations in multiple jurisdictions. This designation affirms its standing as the authorized legal steward of the broader 50501 movement and allows it to enter contracts, hold intellectual property, and provide formal recognition to affiliated bodies.

All legal documents, registrations, financial instruments, and public representations shall use this name in full. The corporation may also operate under approved alternate stylizations such as "50501", "50501 Movement", or other derivative names so long as they comply with all applicable trademark laws and internal brand governance policies.

Section 1.2 – Purpose

50501 Inc. exists to serve as the legal, administrative, and infrastructural backbone of the national 50501 movement—a decentralized, people-powered network of grassroots organizers committed to justice, equity, and collective resistance.

The core purpose of 50501 Inc. is to:

- Legally protect the movement's name, symbols, and brand identity through federal trademark registration and enforcement;
- Support decentralized grassroots organizing by providing chapters with legal legitimacy, access to financial infrastructure, digital tools, and logistical resources;
- Ensure compliance with nonprofit and advocacy laws, reducing the administrative burden on local chapters and individual organizers;
- Maintain structural integrity without exerting control, by enabling shared tools, processes, and protections while preserving full chapter autonomy.

50501 Inc. shall not engage in centralized command-and-control governance. It shall never override the democratic decisions of local, state, or identity-based chapters except where required to enforce trademark usage, protect the organization's nonprofit status, or ensure legal compliance.

This corporation is not a headquarters—it is a shield, a platform, and a resource engine for those doing the work on the ground. Its mandate is to empower the movement's base, defend its infrastructure from bad actors or institutional sabotage, and ensure that no chapter, collective, or organizer is ever left legally exposed or structurally unsupported.

50501 Inc. is committed to upholding the principles of nonviolence, anti-racism, queer liberation, accessibility, transparency, and grassroots decentralization. It does not exist for profit, hierarchy, or institutional self-preservation, but to honor the urgency, power, and plurality of the movement it serves.

Article II – Board of Directors

Section 2.1 – Composition

The Board of Directors shall consist of ten (10) voting members, who together hold collective fiduciary responsibility for the governance, oversight, and strategic guidance of 50501 Inc. Board members shall be selected based on alignment with the organization's mission, demonstrated leadership in grassroots organizing, and a public commitment to decentralized, inclusive activism.

The Board shall be composed as follows:

Officers (4)

Officers are responsible for the executive coordination and internal management of the organization. These roles are distinct and non-hierarchical but carry defined responsibilities:

- President
- Vice President
- Secretary
- Treasurer

Regional Representatives (6)

One (1) representative shall be elected from each of the following geographic regions to ensure equitable national representation:

- Northeast Region
- Southeast Region
- Midwest Region

- Southwest Region
- Northwest Region
- Pacific Region

Each Regional Representative shall act as a conduit between the Board and verified chapters in their area, ensuring that localized concerns are reflected in national strategy and governance. These representatives shall serve as advocates for decentralized coordination, regional autonomy, and chapter support.

To maintain equitable voice and balance, no individual may serve simultaneously as both an officer and a regional representative.

Section 2.2 – Term of Office

All Board members shall serve one (1) year terms, commencing on the date of certification or appointment, and concluding after twelve (12) calendar months unless reelected.

Board members may serve up to three (3) consecutive terms in the same role, after which they must rotate off for at least one full term before being eligible for that same position again. This term limit ensures leadership rotation, prevents concentration of power, and strengthens collective governance.

Reappointments must occur through a transparent, public, and participatory vote of the active verified membership or a quorum thereof, in accordance with organizational election procedures.

Section 2.3 – Selection and Succession

Selection Process

- All Board seats shall be filled through a public application process, accompanied by a vetting and interview phase conducted by a nominating committee or independent review panel.
- All applicants must be active members in good standing, with a proven record of ethical leadership, alignment with 50501's values, and commitment to grassroots decentralization.
- The final slate of candidates shall be subject to democratic vote by verified chapter representatives or the national base, as defined in the organization's election guidelines.

Non-Transferability

- Under no circumstance may a Board seat be assigned, inherited, gifted, sold, or otherwise transferred.
- Each seat represents an active public trust and shall be held only by the person duly elected or appointed.

Filling Vacancies

- In the event of a vacancy (due to resignation, removal, or disqualification), the remaining Board members shall hold an interim vote within fourteen (14) days to appoint a temporary replacement.
- This interim appointment must then be subject to a full membership confirmation vote within sixty (60) days to either ratify the appointee or elect a new member.
- If a vacancy results in the Board falling below the quorum threshold (seven members), no high-risk or policy decisions may be made until the seat is filled and quorum is re-established.

Section 2.4 – Conflict of Interest

All Board members are required to act with integrity, independence, and loyalty to the organization always. To ensure ethical governance:

- Each Board member must disclose any potential, perceived, or actual conflicts of interest, including financial interests, family relationships, or organizational affiliations that may influence their impartiality.
- Such disclosures must be made in writing and recorded in the Board's official records.
- Board members shall sign a Conflict-of-Interest Disclosure Form upon onboarding and update it annually or upon material change in status.

Failure to disclose a conflict, or to recuse oneself from a related vote or discussion, shall constitute grounds for investigation and possible removal under Article VI. The organization reserves the right to seek legal counsel or initiate internal review proceedings if a conflict jeopardizes the nonprofit's standing, integrity, or public trust.

Article III – Duties of Officers

The officers of 50501 Inc. are responsible for executing the strategic vision, ensuring operational integrity, and maintaining ethical leadership within the organization. Officers shall act collaboratively, with mutual accountability and a shared commitment to the mission of decentralized empowerment and grassroots protection.

Section 3.1 – President

The President serves as the organizational anchor and the primary public representative of 50501 Inc. This role requires a high level of visibility, diplomacy, and vision.

- Serves as the primary spokesperson for the organization, articulating the mission, goals, and values of the 50501 movement to external partners, the media, donors, and the general public.
- Chairs all board meetings, ensuring fair facilitation, agenda preparation, and effective time management during discussions and votes.
- Leads strategic coordination across officer and regional functions, ensuring that board initiatives align with organizational priorities, emerging risks, and grassroots needs.
- Represents the organization in high-level partnerships, formal collaborations, and joint advocacy efforts, always preserving the decentralized ethos of the movement.
- May delegate specific speaking or coordination responsibilities to other officers when appropriate, while retaining overall leadership and accountability.

The President shall not act unilaterally on behalf of the Board unless authorized by majority or unanimous vote where required. They serve as a collaborative steward, not an executive authority.

Section 3.2 – Vice President

The Vice President supports the President and plays a critical role in maintaining internal balance, conflict resolution, and operational resilience.

- Assists the President in carrying out day-to-day leadership functions and assumes all presidential responsibilities in their temporary absence or incapacity.
- Oversees internal operations, including management of working groups, ad hoc committees, and special projects requiring interdepartmental coordination.
- Leads conflict resolution efforts, ensuring all internal disagreements among board members or with chapters are handled respectfully, transparently, and in accordance with movement values.
- Acts as the liaison between the officers (President, Secretary, Treasurer) and the Regional Representatives, facilitating clear communication, feedback loops, and collaborative decision-making.
- May also be tasked with onboarding new board members, overseeing code of conduct enforcement, or leading strategic planning retreats as needed.

The Vice President shall serve as a bridge-builder, ensuring all parts of the board function as a united, values-aligned body.

Section 3.3 – Secretary

The Secretary serves as the organization's memory, documentation officer, and transparency steward.

- Maintains all official records, including meeting minutes, attendance logs, vote tallies, board decisions, chapter verification records, and conflict disclosures.
- Ensures documentation accuracy and timely archiving, in compliance with legal requirements, nonprofit best practices, and internal bylaws.
- Coordinates the publication of board summaries, meeting notes, and organizational updates to verified chapters and, where applicable, the public.
- Ensures all Board meeting notices, agendas, and follow-up documentation are distributed promptly and in accordance with the bylaws.
- Collaborates with the President and Vice President to ensure proper documentation of board resolutions, actions taken outside meetings, and emergency decisions.
- May act as the point person for responding to FOIA requests, nonprofit compliance audits, or document inspection requests from authorized parties.

The Secretary shall uphold the principles of transparency, accessibility, and historical continuity, ensuring that every action taken by the Board is traceable and defensible.

Section 3.4 – Treasurer

The Treasurer is responsible for the financial oversight, compliance, and integrity of 50501 Inc.'s fiscal operations.

- Oversees all organizational bank accounts, financial ledgers, budgets, audits, and disbursement records. This includes both national finances and infrastructure for chapter-level financial systems.
- Manages chapter disbursements, including the issuance and maintenance of prepaid debit cards, reconciliation of transactions, and distribution of approved expense reimbursements.
- Ensures all financial filings with the IRS, the Commonwealth of Virginia, the District of Columbia, and other regulatory bodies are submitted accurately and on time.
- Implements financial tracking and reporting systems that ensure real-time visibility into income, expenses, chapter balances, and movement-wide fiscal trends.
- Presents a quarterly financial report to the full Board and a public annual financial summary to all verified chapters and stakeholders.

- Coordinates with external accountants, legal counsel, or audit firms for independent review as needed.

The Treasurer shall operate with fiscal transparency, accountability, and ethical stewardship, ensuring that all resources serve the mission and comply with nonprofit law.

Article IV – Trademark Ownership and Security

50501 Inc. holds exclusive legal ownership and stewardship over the name, branding, and intellectual property associated with the 50501 movement. This authority exists to prevent misuse, protect the integrity of the movement's identity, and ensure legal defensibility against bad-faith actors or opportunistic exploitation.

The following provisions establish how these intellectual properties are shared, governed, and protected.

Section 4.1 – Shared Ownership

The following federally registered service marks constitute the official trademarks of the organization and are recognized as the legal property of 50501 Inc., a Virginia nonprofit corporation:

- “50501” – United States Patent and Trademark Office (USPTO) Serial No. 99122369
- “50 Protests. 50 States. 1 Movement.” – USPTO Serial No. 99122956

These trademarks are collectively held in equal, undivided custodianship by the ten (10) members of the Board of Directors. Each board member shall possess a 1/10 fractional custodial share, which conveys a non-transferable fiduciary responsibility for the duration of their term. This share is not a property right, but a temporary legal stewardship bound by duty to the movement and the organization.

Custodianship is purely functional and symbolic, intended to reflect shared accountability and deter unilateral decision-making over the organization's identity. These shares carry no financial valuation, assignable equity, or commercial use rights.

Section 4.2 – Restrictions on Transfer

To prevent exploitation or dilution of the brand, the following restrictions apply to all board members:

- No board member may sell, license, transfer, delegate, or encumber their custodial share of any 50501 trademark under any circumstances—whether for personal benefit, strategic collaboration, or otherwise.
- Upon resignation, removal, or term expiration, a board member shall immediately and unconditionally forfeit all custodial rights to the trademarks without need for further action. This forfeiture is automatic, final, and irrevocable.
- All individuals assuming board membership must sign a binding legal affidavit acknowledging these terms, including pre-consent to automatic forfeiture upon departure from the board.
- The board shall maintain a central custodial register detailing current stewards of the trademarks, updated quarterly by the Secretary and retained as part of the organization's official records.

No custodial share may be inherited, transferred, held in trust, or subdivided. These protections are in place to guard against internal consolidation of power and prevent any misuse of the organization's intellectual assets.

Section 4.3 – Protection and Amendments

The trademarks of 50501 Inc. are to be treated as sacred movement assets, and any modification or reallocation must follow an uncompromising standard of board consensus.

- No changes may be made to the registration, licensing, ownership, or usage policies of either trademark without a unanimous vote (10 out of 10) by the full Board of Directors.
- Unanimity shall be required for the following:
 - Surrendering ownership of a trademark
 - Assigning rights to external entities
 - Releasing trademarks into the public domain
 - Updating or rebranding marks in a way that alters their registered meaning, character, or scope
- Any proposed change must be submitted in writing to the full Board at least 14 days prior to the vote, accompanied by a legal impact analysis and, if applicable, a statement of rationale from the President or proposing officer.
- Approved changes must be filed with the USPTO in compliance with federal trademark law and communicated to all verified chapters within seven (7) calendar days of implementation.

The purpose of these restrictions is not to limit organizational evolution, but to safeguard the collective identity of the movement, which was built by hundreds of decentralized organizers and belongs to none exclusively.

Article V – Voting and Decision-Making

The Board of Directors of 50501 Inc. shall operate as a deliberative, democratic body, grounded in collaborative governance and empowered by procedural integrity. Decision-making processes shall reflect the organization's commitment to transparency, collective accountability, and decentralized leadership.

All board actions—whether routine or extraordinary—must follow formal voting protocols as outlined below. All votes must be recorded in writing by the Secretary and included in the official board minutes, with tallies disclosed upon request to verified chapters.

Section 5.1 – Standard Voting Threshold

A two-thirds (2/3) majority, or seven (7) out of ten (10) voting members of the Board of Directors, shall be required to approve all routine and operational matters, including but not limited to:

- Annual budgets and quarterly financial modifications
- Policy proposals, procedural guidelines, or internal governance documents (e.g., campaign standards, ethics codes)
- Approval of new chapter affiliations or termination of chapter status due to inactivity or voluntary withdrawal
- Operational decisions including infrastructure changes, hiring of consultants or contractors, and major vendor or service agreements
- Advisory board nominations, working group formation, and movement-wide initiatives
- Communications strategy decisions that materially affect the public messaging or positioning of 50501 Inc.

All voting under this section must be conducted in one of the following formats:

- In-person or virtual board meeting, where quorum (7 or more board members) is established
- Asynchronous vote via secure encrypted channel (e.g., ProtonMail or Signal), provided that:
 - A clear motion is distributed in writing
 - A minimum 72-hour voting window is provided
 - The Secretary verifies and logs all responses

Votes failing to meet the 2/3 majority threshold shall be considered not approved and must be reintroduced with amendments or withdrawn.

No vote under this section may proceed if fewer than seven (7) board members are currently seated due to vacancies. In such cases, interim appointments must be made before binding decisions resume.

Section 5.2 – Unanimous Voting Requirements

Certain high-impact actions shall require unanimous consent (10 out of 10 votes) by the full and seated Board of Directors, without exception or abstention. These include:

- Modification, reassignment, surrender, or sale of organizational trademarks
This includes any attempt to assign ownership, update registered marks, release control to another entity, or discontinue enforcement.
- Amendments to these bylaws
Any proposed change to the bylaws must be distributed in writing to the full board at least fourteen (14) days in advance of the vote. Amendments may only be adopted upon full agreement of all ten (10) voting members.
- Corporate dissolution or sale
Any decision to dissolve 50501 Inc., merge with another entity, or liquidate organizational assets shall require a full board vote and formal legal counsel review prior to consideration.
- Removal of a sitting board member
Removal for cause—including misconduct, fiduciary breach, or values violations—shall only be permitted by a 9-out-of-9 vote, excluding the member under review. The affected board member may not vote or influence deliberations regarding their own status and must be recused from the entire process.

Additional Provisions:

- All unanimous votes must be conducted through synchronous deliberation (in-person or virtual meeting) unless otherwise approved by a prior unanimous vote to allow asynchronous action.
- The Secretary must record the exact language of the motion, the vote count, and verification that no abstentions or recusals (except for removal proceedings) occurred.
- Once enacted, the outcomes of unanimous votes shall be communicated to all verified chapters within seven (7) calendar days, including rationale and any applicable implementation timeline.

The purpose of this section is to establish firm safeguards over decisions that materially affect the mission, identity, continuity, or legal standing of the organization.

Article VI – Removal and Vacancies

50501 Inc. is governed by individuals entrusted with the legal, ethical, and strategic stewardship of a national movement. As such, the removal of a Board member—whether for cause or through voluntary resignation—must be executed with clear standards, formal procedures, and unambiguous enforcement mechanisms.

This article outlines the grounds, process, and consequences of board member removal, as well as the procedures for handling vacancies in a manner that preserves organizational continuity and legal integrity.

Section 6.1 – Removal for Cause

A sitting member of the Board of Directors may be forcibly removed from office by a unanimous vote (9 out of 9) of the remaining members of the Board, excluding the individual subject to removal. The member in question shall be recused from all discussions, deliberations, and votes related to their removal.

A removal may only occur for one or more of the following formal grounds for cause:

- Breach of fiduciary duty, including failure to act in the best interest of the organization, conflict of interest violations, or actions that compromise the nonprofit's legal or financial standing.
- Misuse of organizational funds, resources, or systems, including but not limited to embezzlement, unauthorized disbursements, unauthorized data access, or improper use of the 50501 name or infrastructure.
- Violation of these bylaws or the core values of the movement, including sustained nonparticipation, sabotage of board decisions, abuse of authority, or public acts of misalignment with the mission of grassroots liberation, equity, and decentralization.
- Harassment, abuse, discrimination, or oppressive behavior, including any form of racism, sexism, homophobia, transphobia, ableism, or targeted harm against another member, chapter, or affiliated community.

Procedural Requirements:

- A formal written complaint must be submitted to the full Board, outlining the alleged misconduct, supporting evidence, and rationale for proposed removal.
- The member under review shall be provided with written notice of the charges at least seven (7) days before the scheduled vote.
- They shall have the opportunity to submit a written response or request a brief appearance before the Board to address the concerns, not exceeding 30 minutes.

- A closed executive session shall be convened for deliberation, with a binding vote immediately following.

If the vote meets the 9-out-of-9 threshold, removal is immediate and final. The individual shall be notified in writing within 24 hours of the decision.

Section 6.2 – Immediate Surrender Requirements

Upon either voluntary resignation or involuntary removal from the Board of Directors, the departing member shall comply with the following mandatory transition obligations, enforceable by organizational policy and legal agreement:

- Automatic forfeiture of trademark custodianship: The individual's 1/10 custodial interest in any organizational trademarks shall be immediately and irrevocably voided. This forfeiture is non-negotiable and does not require a separate vote or consent.
- Immediate revocation of access: All internal access privileges—including but not limited to email accounts, cloud storage, digital workspaces, communication platforms (e.g., Signal, ProtonMail, Matrix), and board voting systems—shall be terminated within twenty-four (24) hours of departure confirmation.
- Mandatory legal relinquishment: The individual shall sign and return a formal Resignation and Legal Relinquishment Agreement within seventy-two (72) hours of removal or resignation. This document shall confirm:
 - Termination of board duties
 - Forfeiture of all intellectual property access or custodianship
 - Agreement not to misrepresent current or past board affiliation in any unauthorized capacity
 - Commitment to maintain confidentiality of sensitive organizational data

Failure to comply with these terms may result in:

- Legal action to enforce trademark and data protections
- Notification to chapters and partners regarding breach of transition procedures
- Revocation of honorary status or exclusion from future involvement

The organization reserves the right to engage legal counsel in any removal or resignation scenario that poses reputational, financial, or operational risk to 50501 Inc. or its affiliates.

Section 6.3 – Interim Appointments and Continuity

In the event of any vacancy—whether due to resignation, removal, or prolonged incapacity—the remaining Board shall initiate a two-part succession process in accordance with Article II, Section 2.3:

1. **Interim Appointment:** An interim replacement may be nominated and approved by a majority vote of the remaining board within fourteen (14) days of the vacancy.
2. **Public Election:** A permanent replacement must be elected through a public application and membership vote within sixty (60) days.

Until a quorum of seven (7) board members is re-established, no binding votes on high-risk or strategic matters shall be permitted.

Article VII – Meetings and Transparency

To fulfill its fiduciary and ethical obligations, the Board of Directors of 50501 Inc. shall meet regularly, maintain open communication with verified chapters, and operate in accordance with the highest standards of transparency. Meetings shall be structured, recorded, and governed in a way that reinforces the organization’s decentralized values and public trust.

Section 7.1 – Meeting Frequency and Procedures

Regular Meetings

- The full Board of Directors shall convene at least once per calendar month for regular business. These meetings may occur in person or virtually, provided that secure, equitable access is ensured for all members.
- Each meeting must include:
 - A formal agenda, distributed by the Secretary at least 48 hours in advance
 - A review of financial updates and chapter activity reports
 - Time allocated for chapter liaison updates and grassroots feedback
 - Review and approval of prior meeting minutes

Emergency Sessions

- Emergency sessions may be called with a minimum of seventy-two (72) hours’ notice by any two (2) voting members of the Board.
- These meetings must state:
 - The explicit purpose for convening
 - Whether a vote will be required
 - Any applicable supporting documentation

- A quorum of at least seven (7) voting board members is required for any emergency session to conduct official business or binding votes.
- Topics eligible for emergency sessions include:
 - Legal threats or time-sensitive compliance risks
 - Urgent financial decisions affecting chapter disbursements or liabilities
 - Immediate threats to organizational security, trademark integrity, or public representation

Special Meetings and Closed Sessions

- Special (non-emergency) sessions may be called to address specific strategic issues (e.g., bylaw reviews, onboarding, chapter grievance hearings).
- Closed executive sessions may be convened for:
 - Personnel matters
 - Legal consultations
 - Board member removal proceedings
 - Confidential negotiations

All meeting formats—regular, emergency, or special—must be formally recorded, documented, and stored for future audit and access.

Section 7.2 – Transparency and Accountability

50501 Inc. is committed to operational transparency and democratic access to information by its verified chapters and stakeholders. The following measures shall apply:

Meeting Minutes

- The Secretary shall prepare comprehensive meeting minutes for all regular and emergency sessions, including:
 - Attendance
 - Motions proposed
 - Voting records (names and tallies)
 - Summaries of deliberations and public comments (when applicable)
 - Any follow-up actions or deadlines assigned
- These minutes shall be made available to all verified chapters through secure access within seven (7) calendar days of each meeting's conclusion.
- Redacted versions may be prepared for public release upon board approval, excluding privileged or sensitive information.

Quarterly Board Summaries

- A quarterly summary report shall be compiled and published by the Secretary, in collaboration with the President and Vice President. This report shall include:

- Major decisions taken by the Board
- Financial highlights and budgetary adjustments
- Chapter affiliation statistics and updates
- Ongoing initiatives or campaigns
- Any known legal, structural, or reputational risks
- These summaries shall be posted publicly on the official 50501 website and distributed to verified chapters via the organization's primary communications channels (e.g., Signal, ProtonMail, Microsoft 365, or future CRM systems).

Public Meeting Notice (Optional Future Provision)

- The Board may opt to create a policy for advance public notification of general meeting dates and non-confidential agenda items, thereby inviting feedback from chapters or observers.

Inspection Rights

- Any verified chapter in good standing may formally request access to organizational records, such as bylaws, prior board decisions, and financial summaries, in accordance with state nonprofit transparency laws. These requests shall be processed within ten (10) business days.

Article VIII – Nonprofit Standing and Public Accountability

As a recognized nonprofit corporation, 50501 Inc. is bound by federal, state, and local laws governing charitable and advocacy-based organizations. In accordance with its mission and legal framework, the organization shall uphold the highest standards of public accountability, financial integrity, and decentralized governance. This article affirms 50501 Inc.'s status as a 501(c)(4) social welfare entity and defines the scope of its relationship with affiliated grassroots chapters.

Section 8.1 – Compliance with 501(c)(4) Requirements

50501 Inc. is incorporated in the Commonwealth of Virginia and registered as a foreign nonprofit entity in the District of Columbia. It is officially recognized by the Internal Revenue Service (IRS) as a 501(c)(4) social welfare organization, operating exclusively to promote the general welfare of communities through advocacy, civic participation, and public education.

To maintain this status, the Board of Directors shall ensure the following ongoing compliance measures:

- **Prohibition on Partisan Activity:**
50501 Inc. shall not directly or indirectly endorse, oppose, contribute to, or coordinate with any candidate for political office at the federal, state, or local level. The organization may engage in issue-based advocacy but must avoid any activities that could be interpreted as electioneering or candidate promotion.
- **Legal and Regulatory Compliance:**
The organization shall operate in accordance with all applicable federal, state, and municipal laws governing nonprofit activities. This includes:
 - Adherence to IRS rules and guidance for 501(c)(4) entities
 - Compliance with state charitable registration requirements, if applicable
 - Compliance with lobbying disclosure and advocacy reporting regulations
- **Timely Filing of Forms and Reports:**
The Treasurer, in coordination with the Secretary and legal advisors, shall ensure the timely submission of all required documents, including:
 - IRS Form 990 or equivalent annual return
 - State-level financial or corporate disclosures
 - Trademark maintenance documents with the USPTO
 - Any required lobbying or grassroots activity disclosures
- **Audit Readiness and Documentation:**
50501 Inc. shall maintain transparent and accurate records of all financial transactions, board decisions, and chapter affiliations. These records shall be securely stored and available for inspection in the event of an IRS audit, donor inquiry, or internal review.
- **Legal Counsel Access:**
The Board may retain independent nonprofit or tax-exempt counsel at any time to review compliance procedures or address emerging legal issues, particularly in high-risk areas such as fundraising, advocacy, or trademark enforcement.

Noncompliance with these standards may endanger the organization's tax-exempt status, public credibility, and legal protections. As such, compliance is a non-negotiable fiduciary responsibility of all board members and officers.

Section 8.2 – Chapter Oversight and Autonomy

50501 Inc. recognizes that its power lies not in central authority, but in the collective strength of its verified chapters—autonomous, grassroots-driven collectives aligned with the movement's core values. The national organization exists not to control, but to support, protect, and legally enable these groups.

To that end:

- **Governance Through MOUs:**
All verified chapters shall be governed through Memoranda of Understanding (MOUs) that outline mutual rights and responsibilities. These agreements:
 - Confirm a chapter's legal use of the 50501 name and trademarks
 - Define the scope of support (e.g., financial tools, legal resources, branding access)
 - Protect chapters from national interference in their day-to-day operations, leadership, or local strategies
 - Provide clarity on disaffiliation, grievance resolution, and conduct standards
- **Respect for Local Autonomy:**
The Board of Directors shall not override or interfere with a chapter's decision-making, internal structure, or campaign priorities unless:
 - The chapter is found to have misused the 50501 trademarks in a way that endangers brand integrity or public trust
 - The chapter engages in financial fraud, misuse of donated funds, or unauthorized use of national resources
 - The chapter commits acts of legal noncompliance that could place 50501 Inc.'s nonprofit standing or liability protections at risk
- **Enforcement with Transparency:**
Any investigation or disciplinary action against a chapter must:
 - Be grounded in documented evidence
 - Be communicated clearly and privately to chapter leadership
 - Offer the chapter an opportunity to respond and provide context
 - Involve a final decision by a two-thirds (2/3) vote of the full Board
- **Empowerment Through Structure:**
The Chapter Affiliation Program is designed to minimize administrative burden and maximize operational freedom. Chapters are not required to incorporate independently or maintain their own tax-exempt status. Instead, they operate under the protective legal umbrella of 50501 Inc., gaining access to:
 - Donation infrastructure
 - Debit card disbursements
 - Protest insurance templates
 - Secure communication platforms
 - Technical and legal guidance

In return, chapters agree to uphold shared values and act in good faith within the collective movement ecosystem.

50501 Inc. will never impose a top-down directive, ideological purity test, or gatekeeping structure. Its role is to amplify, not command. Autonomy, diversity of tactics, and local self-determination are not just tolerated—they are celebrated as the core drivers of meaningful change.

Article IX – Amendments to Bylaws

These bylaws constitute the foundational governing document of 50501 Inc. and are legally binding upon the Board of Directors, verified chapters, officers, and any affiliated partners. As such, any changes to these bylaws must be approached with deliberation, transparency, and organizational consensus to ensure the continued alignment of governance with the mission, legal standing, and decentralized ethos of the movement.

Section 9.1 – Unanimous Approval Requirement

No amendments, deletions, or additions to these bylaws shall be valid unless approved by a unanimous vote (10 out of 10) of the currently seated Board of Directors.

- This vote must occur during a scheduled meeting at which quorum is established, and all board members are present (virtually or physically), unless exceptional written justification is submitted in advance by a temporarily unavailable board member.
- Abstentions shall not be permitted. All ten (10) members must vote affirmatively for an amendment to be adopted.
- Board members under investigation for misconduct or in active removal proceedings shall be ineligible to vote on amendments during the investigation period.

This high threshold reflects the gravity of altering the organization's legal framework and prevents any single faction or majority from unilaterally reshaping the core principles of the organization.

Section 9.2 – Proposal and Review Process

Proposed amendments to the bylaws must follow a clear procedural path prior to a final vote:

1. Submission
 - Any current board member may propose a bylaw amendment by submitting the full written text of the proposed change to the Secretary.
 - The proposal must include:
 - The exact language to be added, removed, or revised
 - A rationale explaining the need for the change
 - A summary of its impact on existing policies and operations

2. Distribution and Notice
 - The Secretary shall circulate the proposed amendment to the full Board no fewer than fourteen (14) calendar days before the scheduled vote.
 - A copy shall also be sent to verified chapter liaisons for nonbinding public comment, with a recommended five-day response window.
3. Deliberation and Legal Review
 - At the discretion of the Board, proposed amendments may be reviewed by legal counsel to ensure compliance with IRS, state, and nonprofit regulations.
 - Proposed changes may be discussed over multiple meetings, but no amendment shall be approved without final language review by the Secretary.
4. Voting and Certification
 - The unanimous vote must be recorded in the meeting minutes.
 - Once passed, the Secretary shall issue a Bylaw Amendment Certification Notice, including the amendment number, date of passage, voting record, and updated language.

Section 9.3 – Chapter Notification and Public Disclosure

To ensure transparency and democratic legitimacy, all adopted amendments must be publicly disclosed in a timely and accessible manner:

- Verified Chapter Notification
 - All verified chapters shall receive the final amended language, rationale, and effective date within seven (7) calendar days of passage.
 - This information shall be delivered via the organization's primary secure communication channels (e.g., Signal, ProtonMail, Microsoft 365).
- Public Website Posting
 - The updated bylaws, with revision history and amendment summary, shall be published to the official 50501 website under the governance section.
- Archiving of Prior Versions
 - The Secretary shall maintain a version-controlled archive of all previous bylaw documents for historical reference and legal audit purposes.

Section 9.4 – Prohibited Bylaw Amendments

The Board shall not introduce or approve any bylaw amendment that:

- Violates federal, state, or local laws governing nonprofit organizations
- Conflicts with the IRS requirements for 501(c)(4) entities
- Enables unilateral board control over verified chapters or undermines their right to autonomous organizing
- Dismantles the requirement for shared trademark custodianship or unanimous approval for dissolution

- Removes or bypasses transparency requirements for financial disclosures, board decisions, or chapter communications

Any such amendment, even if passed by unanimous vote, shall be considered null, void, and unenforceable, and may trigger legal review or disaffiliation of involved members.

Article X – Definitions

The following terms are defined for clarity and consistency throughout these bylaws and all related governance documents of 50501 Inc. These definitions are binding and should be interpreted in alignment with the values, legal structure, and mission of the organization.

Verified Chapter

A Verified Chapter is defined as any local, regional, or identity-based organizing body that has:

- Successfully completed the 50501 Chapter Affiliation Application
- Participated in the verification and onboarding process
- Entered a legally recognized Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) with 50501 Inc.
- Been formally acknowledged as an official chapter through a Board vote or administrative certification

Verified Chapters are entitled to:

- Operate publicly under the “50501” name and branding
- Receive access to national infrastructure, including fundraising, legal, digital, and financial tools
- Participate in movement-wide initiatives and collaborative decision-making
- Retain full operational autonomy, subject only to the terms outlined in the MOU and compliance with legal and ethical standards

Chapters not in good standing—due to disaffiliation, fraud, or values violations—may have their verified status revoked through a formal process outlined in these bylaws and their MOU.

Trademark Share

A Trademark Share refers to a temporary, non-transferable custodianship interest held by each currently seated member of the 50501 Inc. Board of Directors in relation to the organization's registered trademarks:

- "50501" – USPTO Serial No. 99122369
- "50 Protests. 50 States. 1 Movement." – USPTO Serial No. 99122956

This share:

- Conveys no monetary value or proprietary ownership
- May not be sold, transferred, inherited, licensed, or pledged
- Exists solely to reinforce equal responsibility among Board members for trademark governance
- Is automatically forfeited upon resignation, removal, or term expiration
- Does not survive beyond active board service

This concept was designed to democratize legal stewardship of the movement's identity and prevent centralized control or unilateral manipulation of core organizational assets.

Fiduciary Duty

Fiduciary Duty refers to the ethical and legal obligation of all board members and officers to act in the best interest of 50501 Inc. and its stakeholders. This duty includes, but is not limited to:

- Duty of Care: Exercising informed, thoughtful, and diligent decision-making in all matters affecting the organization
- Duty of Loyalty: Placing the organization's mission and integrity above personal, financial, or political interests; avoiding conflicts of interest
- Duty of Obedience: Ensuring that all actions align with the mission, bylaws, legal status, and tax-exempt purpose of the organization
- Duty of Confidentiality: Protecting sensitive organizational information, including data related to chapters, donors, legal issues, and digital infrastructure

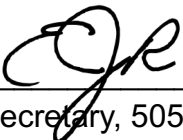
Violation of fiduciary duty may constitute grounds for removal and may expose the offending party to civil or legal liability, especially in cases involving financial harm, negligence, or willful misconduct.

CERTIFICATION OF ADOPTION

These Bylaws of 50501 Inc. were reviewed in full and unanimously adopted by the sitting Board of Directors in accordance with Article IX on the date below. These bylaws shall take full legal effect as of the date of certification and remain in force unless formally amended pursuant to the provisions herein.

Executed this 22nd day of April 2025, by the following officers:

Parker [REDACTED]
President, 50501 Inc.



Secretary, 50501 Inc. (*Not yet appointed*)